



(Don't Write
anything in this Area)

- (b) Culture is unique to human beings. Do you agree? Present arguments in favour and against the statement. (15 marks)

Culture has many definitions.

E.B. Tylor defined it as 'that complex whole that consists of beliefs, customs, morals, arts, traditions acquired by man as a part of society'.

Arguments in favour:

(i) According to Tylor's definition, culture is specific to man. It is defined in very way that man acquires it as a part of society.

(ii) It is also seen that language is an important medium in transmitting culture. Since, language is unique to man, culture is unique to man.

(iii) The modes of enculturation and acculturation are only seen in man and hence culture is unique to man.

~~(iv)~~

Arguments against:

(i) Tools are used by even *Homo Habilis* and *Homo Erectus* thus culture may not be unique to *Homo Sapiens*.

(ii) Some evidences show that even *Australopithecus* may have used bone tools.

(iii) The evidences of Shanidar cave show that religion or soul may have started at the time of neanderthals. Thus, culture may have existed before humans.

(iv) Many primates like chimpanzees exhibit cultural characteristics such

as group living, grooming thus culture may not be unique to man.

(v) Many birds also practice social control like strict lifetime monogamy thus exhibiting cultural traits.

Unless the definition of culture is not rigid, it is not possible to answer whether culture is unique to man. Good evidences are found earlier to man whereas social living is seen in other primates as well thus culture may not be unique to humans when defined broadly.